

Present Perfect

USES

We use the Present Perfect to talk about:

- **recent actions** – e.g. At 18:00, Anne arrived home. At 18:01, we can say: Anne **has arrived** home.
- **something that happened in the past, but we do not say exactly when it happened** – e.g. *I've seen this film before.*
- **an action which started in the past and continuous up to now** – examples:
 - ✓ *I have been a teacher for more than ten years.*
 - ✓ *We haven't seen Janine since Friday.*
 - ✓ *How long have you been at this school?*

Tip! We often use **since** and **for** to say how long the action has lasted.

- **a past action that has the result in the present** – examples:
 - ✓ *I have lost my wallet. = I don't have it now.*
 - ✓ *Jimmy has gone to South America. = He isn't here now.*
 - ✓ *Have you finished your homework? = Is your homework ready?*

We often use *the Present Perfect* with **ever** (= at any time) and **never** (= at no time) – e.g. ***Have you ever met a famous person?***

We can also use *the Present Perfect* with **for** and **since**, to talk about situations or actions in a period of time from the past until now. We use **for** with a period of time (e.g. **three months**) and **since** with a point in time (e.g. **Tuesday**).

Examples: We **have lived** here **for** six months.

I **haven't seen** Tom **since** Tuesday.

FORM

1. We form *the Present Perfect* using the Simple Present tense of the **verb To Have** + the **past participle of the main verb** – examples:

Affirmative

- I/you **have arrived** // I/you've arrived
- He/She/It **has arrived** // He/She/It's arrived
- We/You/They **have arrived** // We/You/They've arrived

Negative

- I/you **have not arrived** (haven't)
- He/She/It **has not arrived** (hasn't)
- We /You/They **have not arrived** (haven't)

Interrogative

- **Have** I/you arrived?
- **Has** he/she/it arrived?
- **Have** we/you/they arrived?

2. *Past Participle of the main verb*

- Regular verbs: just add **–ed** (see the rule of *Simple Past*)
- Irregular verbs (check the table)